

with all their unclean deeds: for all their deeds are fornication and lust, and there is no righteousness with them, for (their deeds) are evil. 2. And I, my son, love thee exceedingly, and my heart and my affection bless thee every hour of the day and watch of the night. 3. And now, my son, hearken to my voice, and do the will of thy mother, and do not take thee a wife of the daughters of this land, but only of the house of my father, and of my father's kindred. Thou wilt take thee a wife of the house of my father, and the Most High God will bless thee, and thy children will be a righteous generation and a holy seed." 4. And then spake Jacob to Rebecca, his mother, and said unto her: "Behold, mother, I am nine weeks of years old, and I neither know nor have I touched any woman, nor have I betrothed myself to any, nor even think of taking me a wife of the daughters of Canaan. 5. For I remember, mother, the words of Abraham, our father, for he commanded me not to take a wife of the daughters of Canaan, but to take me a wife from the seed of my father's house and from my kindred. 6. I have heard before that daughters have been born to Laban, thy brother, and I have set my heart on them to take a wife from amongst them. 7. And for this reason I have guarded myself in my spirit against sinning or being corrupted in all my ways throughout all the days of my life; for with regard to lust and fornication, Abraham, my father, gave me many commands. 8. And, despite all that he has commanded me, these two and twenty years my brother has

3. Cf. Gen. xxviii. 1, 2.

4. *Nine weeks.* If the date in ver. 1 is right, it follows that since Jacob was then sixty-three years old, he was born in 2046. This agrees with MSS reading in xix. 13; but the estimate based on that reading is at variance with that which follows from xlv. 13, which assigns Jacob's birth to the year 2041. With the statement as to Jacob's age cf. Ber. rabba 68: "Our father Jacob was sixty-three years old when he received

the blessing: fourteen years he spent hidden in the house of Eber and seven years he served for Rachael: accordingly he was eighty-four when he married, but Esau was forty." See also Seder Olam ii.

I neither know . . . any woman. Syncellus (i. 197) wrongly attributes this statement to Josephus: 'Ιώσηπος φησιν ὅτι ὁ 'Ιακώβ ἐτῶν ὑπάρχων ξγ' οὐκ ἔγνω ὅλως γυναῖκα, ὡς αὐτὸς ἐξείπε τῇ μητρὶ 'Ρεβέκκα.

7. *With regard to . . . fornication*

striven with me, and spoken frequently to me and said: 'My brother, take to wife a sister of my two wives'; but I refuse to do as he has done. 9. I swear before thee, mother, that all the days of my life I will not take me a wife from the daughters of the seed of Canaan, and I will not act wickedly as my brother has done. 10. Fear not mother; be assured that I shall do thy will and walk in uprightness, and not corrupt my ways for ever." 11. And thereupon she lifted up her face to heaven and extended the fingers of her hands, and opened her mouth and blessed the Most High God, who had created the heaven and the earth, and she gave Him thanks and praise. 12. And she said: "Blessed be the Lord God, and may His holy name be blessed for ever and ever, who has given me Jacob as a pure son and a holy seed; for he is Thine, and Thine shall his seed be continually and throughout all the generations for evermore. 13. Bless him, O Lord, and place in my mouth the blessing of righteousness, that I may bless him." 14. And at that hour, when the spirit of righteousness descended into her mouth, she placed both her hands on the head of Jacob, and said:

15. "Blessed art thou, Lord of righteousness and God of the ages;

And may He bless thee beyond all the generations of men.

May He give thee, my son, the path of righteousness,

And reveal righteousness to thy seed.

16. And may He make thy sons many during thy life,

And may they arise according to the number of the months of the year.

Abraham . . . gave me many commands. Cf. xx. 4, xxxix. 6.

8. *These two and twenty years.* This agrees with the statement of Esau's age in Gen. xxvi. 34, where he is said to have been forty when he married. Esau was now sixty-three.

14. *Spirit of righteousness* (or "truth") = τὸ πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας. Cf. John xiv. 17, xv. 26, xvi. 13. So *abd.* Cf. xxxi. 12. *c* reads "Holy Spirit." The latter is Jewish also: cf. Is. lxiii. 10, 11 "His holy Spirit" (רוח קדש). With the idea conveyed by

And may their sons become many and great beyond the
stars of heaven,

And their numbers be more than the sand of the sea.

17. And may He give them this goodly land—as He said He
would give it to Abraham and to his seed after him
always—

And may they hold it as a possession for ever.

18. And may I see (born) unto thee, my son, blessed children
during my life,

And a blessed and holy seed may all thy seed be.

19. And as thou hast refreshed thy mother's spirit during
†my† life,

The womb of her that bare thee blesses thee,

[My affection] and my breasts bless thee

And my mouth and my tongue praise thee greatly.

20. Increase and spread over the earth,

And may thy seed be perfect in the joy of heaven and
earth for ever ;

And may thy seed rejoice,

And on the great day of peace may it have peace.

21. And may thy name and thy seed endure to all the ages,
And may the Most High God be their God,

And may the God of righteousness dwell with them,

And by them may His sanctuary be built unto all the ages.

both phrases cf. Deut. xxxiv. 9 "the spirit of wisdom" (רוח הכמה); Num. xi. 25, 26, 29; Neh. ix. 20; Is. xi. 2.

17. *As He said He would give it to Abraham and to his seed . . . always.* Cf. Luke i. 55, καθὼς ἐλάλησεν . . . τῷ Ἀβραάμ καὶ τῷ σπέρματι αὐτοῦ εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα. The words in Luke recall both Mic. vii. 20 and our text. Observe that this statement in Luke is added parenthetically or explanatorily as in our text.

Possession for ever. Cf. the Thucydidean phrase κτήμα ἐς αἶν.

19. *Hast refreshed (ab).* *cd* "has given thee rest."

†*My*†. Read "thy," as the sense requires it.

[*My affection*]. I have bracketed this phrase; for it comes in awkwardly between "womb," "breasts," "mouth," and "tongue." We should expect an "and" to precede it. It may be a dittography and have originated as a false alternative rendering of רֶחֶם, "womb."

21. *His sanctuary . . . unto all the ages.* Cf. i. 29.

22. Blessed be he that blesseth thee,
And all flesh that curseth thee falsely may it be
cursed."
23. And she kissed him, and said to him :
"May the Lord of the world love thee
As the heart of thy mother and her affection rejoice in
thee and bless thee."
And she ceased from blessing.

Isaac sends Esau for venison, 1-4. Rebecca instructs Jacob to obtain the blessing, 5-9. Jacob under the person of Esau obtains it, 10-24. Esau brings in his venison and by his importunity obtains a blessing, 25-34. Threatens Jacob, 35. (Cf. Gen. xxvii.)

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XXVI. And in the seventh year of this week Isaac called Esau, his elder son, and said unto him : "I am old, my son, and behold my eyes are dim in seeing, and I know not the day of my death. 2. And now take thy hunting weapons thy quiver and thy bow, and go out to the field, and hunt and catch me (venison), my son, and make me savoury meat, such as my soul loveth, and bring it to me that I may eat, and that my soul may bless thee before I die." 3. But Rebecca heard Isaac speaking to Esau. 4. And Esau went forth early to the field to hunt and catch and bring home to his father. 5. And Rebecca called Jacob, her son, and said unto him : "Behold, I heard Isaac, thy father, speak unto Esau, thy brother, saying : ' Hunt for me, and make me savoury meat, and bring (it) to me that I may eat and bless thee before the Lord before I die.' 6. And now, my son, obey my voice in that which I command thee : Go

22. Cf. Gen. xxvii. 29.

23. Cf. Sir. iv. 10.

XXVI. Cf. Gen. xxvii. 1-41.

1. *Are dim in seeing.* An imperfect

rendering of Gen. xxvii. 1 which = "dim so that he could not see (נֶאֱמָר)."

2. *Hunt and catch* = θήρευσον καὶ ἐπιλάβου, a loose rendering of the phrase in Gen. xxvii. 3.